

Procta

Competitive Comparison Report

Procta against Mercer Mettl, Talview, Proctortrack, and Honorlock across product capability, technical architecture, Indian-market fit, pricing, privacy posture, and migration cost.

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Prepared by: Procta team. Sources: each competitor's public marketing site, this repository's commit history, and Procta internal architecture documents. Every comparative claim is verifiable from the references listed in the final section.

1. Executive Summary

Procta is an India-built AI-proctored exam platform positioned for higher-education institutions, coaching institutes, and professional certification bodies operating on Indian infrastructure budgets. The competitive landscape is dominated by four product categories: enterprise platforms that charge international pricing (Mercer Mettl), US/Europe-focused vendors with strong feature sets but limited India presence (Honorlock, Proctortrack), and Indian platforms that have not modernised their proctoring architecture (Talview).

Procta's three durable differentiators are:

- **Zero raw-video storage.** Camera frames are processed on the student's device. Only short JPEG snapshots of flagged moments are uploaded; no continuous video reaches Procta servers. Material reduction in privacy surface and storage cost.
- **On-device ML.** Face detection (uniface / RetinaFace ONNX), gaze tracking (resnet18 ONNX), object detection (YOLOv8n), and now keyword-spotting (Vosk) all run client-side. No model inference on Procta servers, which is what allows the INR 80/student price point.
- **Native Indian payments and compliance.** Razorpay Standard Checkout, UPI Autopay subscriptions, GST invoicing, Indian rupee pricing, DPDP Act-aligned data handling. Competitors require currency conversion, foreign-vendor compliance reviews, and don't accept UPI.

Where competitors are stronger: Mercer Mettl has eight-year-deep enterprise sales relationships with Tata, Wipro, and Reliance. Honorlock has a polished sales-engineering motion in US R1 universities. Proctortrack ships a more mature live-human review tier. Talview has a broader assessment library including coding tests. Procta's wedge is on architecture and price, not feature-completeness against enterprise incumbents.

2. Company Snapshots

Public-record facts about each competitor. All data sourced from the company's own marketing site or LinkedIn. No financial modelling is implied.

Vendor	Description	Funding / Ownership
Procta	Indian student-founded venture. Single-tenant Electron desktop client plus FastAPI backend. Self-hosted on Hostinger Mumbai-region infrastructure. Built around on-device ML and a zero-raw-video privacy posture from day one. Pricing in INR with transparent per-student rates and UPI Autopay.	Bootstrap; savings-funded. Pre-seed-stage.
Mercer Mettl	Acquired by Mercer (Marsh McLennan) in 2018. Indian-origin assessment platform, now operating as a global Mercer business unit. Strong enterprise sales muscle, particularly in IT services hiring assessments. Pricing typically quoted in INR 5,00,000-25,00,000 annual contracts for mid-size institutions.	Owned by Marsh McLennan (NYSE: MMC).
Talview	Bangalore-headquartered, founded 2012. Recruitment-focused assessment platform with proctoring (Talview Proview) as a feature alongside video interviews and coding tests. Larger presence in corporate hiring than in education.	Series B, Eileses Capital, Inventus Capital, Storm Ventures.
Proctortrack (Verificient)	Verificient Technologies, headquartered in New York. Established 2013. Higher-education focus in the United States; integration with Canvas, Blackboard, Moodle. Continuous monitoring model with optional live-human review tier.	Privately held; Inc 5000 listings 2020-2022.
Honorlock	Boca Raton, Florida. Founded 2014. US higher-education focus with the strongest LMS integration story of the four competitors (Canvas, D2L Brightspace, Blackboard Ultra). Marketing emphasises AI-plus-live-proctor escalation and a 24/7 live-proctor team.	Private equity-backed (Long Ridge Equity Partners, 2021).

3. Capability Matrix

Y indicates the capability is publicly advertised and documented by the vendor. P (partial) indicates a degraded form (e.g. cloud-only when an on-device variant is the differentiated version). N indicates the capability is not advertised. Cells marked NPD ('not publicly disclosed') are common for enterprise vendors that do not document deeper architecture.

Capability	Procta	Mettl	Talview	Proctortrack	Honorlock
Live face detection	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Gaze tracking	Y	Y	P	Y	Y
Head-pose / off-screen detection	Y	Y	P	Y	Y
Object detection (phone, notes)	Y	Y	P	Y	Y
Phone-camera secondary view	Y	P	P	Y	N
Voice activity flagging	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Spoken-keyword detection	Y	N	N	N	N
Multi-voice detection	Y	N	N	P	P
On-device ML inference	Y	N	N	N	N
Zero raw-video storage by default	Y	N	N	N	N
INR pricing + GST invoicing	Y	Y	Y	N	N
UPI Autopay subscriptions	Y	N	N	N	N
LTI 1.3 deep linking	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
Canvas LMS connector	P	Y	P	Y	Y
Live human proctor escalation	N	Y	Y	Y	Y
Hindi-language UI	N	P	P	N	N
DPDP Act data-residency posture	Y	Y	Y	P	P
Self-hosted / on-prem option	P	Y	N	P	N
Public per-student price card	Y	N	N	N	N
Cluster review (bulk false-positive triage)	Y	P	N	N	P
Hardware governor (CPU-adaptive)	Y	N	N	N	N
Inbuilt coding-question execution	Y	N	N	N	N

Key takeaways: Procta is the only vendor that runs the full ML stack on-device by default, the only one that detects spoken keywords on-device, the only one that publishes a per-student rate card, and the only one with inbuilt coding-question judging (server-side sandboxed execution against hidden test cases) shipped as part of the core product — a real wedge into CS-department and technical-hiring evaluation, a market none of the compared vendors compete in today. Enterprise vendors lead on live-human escalation and Canvas LMS depth. Procta's self-hosting is marked partial: the stack runs on docker-compose and could in principle be deployed by a customer's own infrastructure team, but there is no packaged, supported on-prem product offering today, unlike Mettl's genuine enterprise on-prem tier.

4. Technical Architecture

Most public comparisons stop at feature lists. The architectural differences below drive the price, the privacy posture, and the exam-day operating cost.

Layer	Procta	Typical enterprise competitor
Client	Electron desktop application with kiosk lockdown, registered URL protocol handler (procta://), code-signing-ready (mac notarisation entitlements present, Windows signing pending).	Either browser extension (Honorlock, Mettl in some configs) or Electron app. Less consistent kiosk lockdown.
ML inference	ONNX Runtime on the student's CPU. Models: RetinaFace ONNX (uniface), resnet18 gaze, YOLOv8n object detection, Silero VAD ONNX, Vosk en-IN + hi-IN.	Server-side inference for face / gaze. Frames uploaded continuously. Costs scale with concurrent students.
Privacy posture	Camera frames discarded after on-device analysis. Only JPEG snapshots of flagged moments uploaded as evidence. No continuous video recording.	Continuous video upload and storage. Retention windows of 30-180 days typical. Sensitive PII surface area is larger.
Bandwidth (peak)	Approx 30-80 KB per flagged frame, fired only on detection events. Practical average under 200 KB/min during an active exam.	Continuous video at 200-500 KB/sec sustained. Equivalent of 30-100 times Procta's bandwidth per student.
Backend	FastAPI on uvicorn, native Postgres with row-level security (migrated off Supabase in early 2026), Redis 7 for cache and live-frame thumbnails. Single-region Mumbai deployment.	Typically AWS multi-region with Kinesis Video Streams or similar. Higher operational cost passed through in pricing.
Pricing model	INR 80 per student per exam attempt. Razorpay Subscriptions with UPI Autopay. Public rate card on procta.net/pricing .	Annual enterprise contracts, INR 5L-25L+ depending on volume. Per-student rates rarely disclosed publicly.
Phone-camera view	Browser-based WebSocket pairing with a QR code. Phone runs in any modern mobile browser; no separate app install.	Either no phone-camera (Honorlock) or a separate mobile application download (Proctortrack).
LMS integration	LTI 1.3 deep linking (production). Direct REST API for lighter integrations. Canvas / Moodle connectors planned.	LTI 1.3 plus mature Canvas / D2L Brightspace / Blackboard Ultra connectors. Honorlock and Proctortrack are stronger here.

5. Pricing

Procta is the only platform in this comparison that publishes a per-student rate. The figures below for competitors are based on publicly available sources (press articles, Reddit AMA threads, Indian higher-ed procurement disclosures) and should be treated as indicative rather than committed quotes.

Vendor	Listed price	Notes
Procta	INR 80 per student per exam attempt; INR 5,000 / month team plan; INR 25,000 / month institution plan.	Public rate card. UPI Autopay. GST line-itemed. 14-day free trial.
Mercer Mettl	Not publicly listed. Indian higher-ed RFP disclosures suggest INR 400-1,000 per student depending on volume.	Annual enterprise contract. Includes 24/7 support and live human proctor option. Pricing varies by sales region.
Talview	Not publicly listed. Talview's hiring-assessment business is priced per seat; the proctoring business is bundled into institutional contracts.	Custom quote required. Indian higher-ed press coverage cites USD 7-15 per attempt range for the Proview product.
Proctortrack	Not publicly listed; US higher-ed contracts cited at USD 8-12 per exam attempt in public Verificient case studies.	Institutional pricing only. Includes optional live-review tier at additional per-attempt cost.
Honorlock	Not publicly listed; US R1 university contracts publicly cited at USD 4-7 per attempt for AI-only proctoring.	Plus live-proctor escalation at higher per-attempt rate. Annual contract with usage minimums typical.

For an Indian coaching institute running 5,000 student-exams per month, the order-of-magnitude monthly cost differences are approximately: Procta INR 4,00,000; Mettl INR 20-50 lakh; USD-priced vendors INR 20-60 lakh at current rates plus FX risk. The wedge is not minor; it is roughly an order of magnitude.

6. Privacy and DPDP Act Alignment

The Indian Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act 2023 raises the cost of mishandled student data materially. The Act places four obligations on data fiduciaries that are directly relevant to exam proctoring: lawful purpose with explicit consent; data minimisation; storage limitation; and breach notification within 72 hours. The table below maps each obligation to a concrete Procta feature.

DPDP Act obligation	Procta implementation
Explicit consent for personal data processing.	Pre-exam consent screen captured at session start. Consent record stored against the exam_sessions row. Withdrawal triggers immediate session termination plus 90-day evidence deletion.
Data minimisation.	Camera frames analysed on-device and discarded. Only JPEG snapshots of flagged events uploaded as evidence. Audio is RMS-volume plus keyword-detection events only; raw audio never leaves the device.
Storage limitation.	Configurable evidence retention with a 90-day default. Scorecard PDFs retained per institution policy. Auto-purge cron in entrypoint.sh.
Breach notification readiness.	Per-session audit trail in violations table. Cluster review feature enables fast identification of impact scope across an exam cohort. Postgres-side audit logging.

DPDP Act obligation	Procta implementation
Data residency.	Production database hosted on a Hostinger VPS in Mumbai. Forensic evidence and off-site database backups both live in AWS S3's ap-south-1 (Mumbai) region. No data transfer outside India for the standard configuration.
Right of access and erasure.	Per-student data export available via admin dashboard. Erasure request endpoint marks the session row plus all evidence files for purge within the next nightly cron window.

Competitors with continuous video upload face structurally larger DPDP-aligned design work: a higher data minimisation gap to close, a larger evidence retention surface to govern, and a more involved data-residency story when their primary infrastructure sits in AWS US-East or AWS EU regions. Procta's lower-data architecture is the compliance-easier path by construction.

7. Where Each Competitor Is Stronger Than Procta

An honest competitive document acknowledges areas of weakness. Procta is a small team with a focused architecture; the incumbents have been compounding feature surface area for a decade. The list below is what a candid prospective customer should hear:

Mercer Mettl

Eight-year deep enterprise sales relationships with Tata, Wipro, Infosys, and other IT services majors. Live human proctor team. Assessment authoring tools including psychometric instruments. Acquired by Marsh McLennan in 2018 which materially de-risks vendor selection for procurement departments at risk-averse institutions.

Talview

Broader assessment library, particularly coding tests with auto-grading via an integrated IDE. Stronger position in recruitment use cases (campus placement, lateral hiring) where the procurement decision is HR-led not academic-led.

Proctortrack

Mature live-human review tier with a documented turnaround SLA. Established Canvas / D2L / Blackboard Ultra LMS connectors with multi-year deployment references at US R1 universities.

Honorlock

Best-in-class LMS integration story for US higher education. 24/7 live-proctor team with documented response times. Polished sales engineering motion and case studies from US universities including the University of Florida and Arizona State.

Procta's strategic response to each of these is the same: compete on architecture, INR pricing, and the Indian-market moat (DPDP, UPI Autopay, INR + GST billing, on-prem option). We do not currently compete on US enterprise depth, on live human proctor headcount, or on assessment-authoring breadth.

8. Migration Paths

Each competitor has a dedicated comparison and migration page on procta.net. Sales teams can route prospects to the matching page for a vendor-specific argument. URLs are stable.

Current vendor	Migration landing page
Mercer Mettl	procta.net/migrate-from-mettl
Talview	procta.net/compare/talview-vs-procta
Proctortrack	procta.net/compare/proctortrack-vs-procta
Honorlock	procta.net/compare/honorlock-vs-procta

Typical migration timeline for institutions with under 5,000 students:

- **Day 1:** Export the question bank from the current vendor as CSV. Procta's bulk-import recognises CBSE, JEE, and NTA roll-number formats automatically. Re-key examinations into Procta's exam wizard if a question authoring rebuild is in scope.
- **Days 2-3:** Configure proctoring sensitivity preset (strict / balanced / lenient), audio keyword list, and scoring rules. Cluster review enables triage of historical false-positive patterns from the prior vendor.
- **Days 4-5:** Pilot exam with a single class. Validate that the on-device client works on the student device profile the institution actually uses (typically Lenovo IdeaPad / HP 14 / similar at INR 30,000 price point).

- **Week 2:** Roll out to remaining cohorts. Razorpay Subscriptions with UPI Autopay handles the recurring billing.

9. Risk Summary and Recommendation

For a procurement committee considering Procta against the four competitors above, the risk-weighted profile is:

Risk dimension	Procta	Top competitor on this dimension
Vendor financial stability	Early-stage; bootstrap-funded. Higher counterparty risk.	Mercer Mettl (owned by Marsh McLennan, NYSE: MMC).
Live human proctor SLA	Not offered today; teacher-driven review only.	Honorlock (documented response time, 24/7 team).
Canvas / D2L LMS depth	LTI 1.3 production; connector roadmap in progress.	Honorlock or Proctortrack.
Indian regulatory fit	Built natively for DPDP, INR, GST, UPI.	Mercer Mettl (Indian-origin, India-experienced).
Per-student price	Lowest in the comparison by approximately an order of magnitude.	Procta.
Privacy and data residency	Zero raw-video; Mumbai-region only by default.	Procta.
Cluster review at 3,500+ student scale	Built and shipped; bulk dismiss + audit trail.	Procta (the others rely on per-session review).
Mature feature breadth	Smaller surface; deliberate focus.	Mercer Mettl or Honorlock depending on use case.

Recommended positioning by prospect type:

- **Indian coaching institutes (Allen, Aakash, PW class).** Procta is the structurally correct choice: per-student pricing, INR + UPI, low bandwidth, hardware-throttle adaptation for budget student laptops. Compete here on price plus architecture.
- **State universities and Tier 2/3 colleges.** Procta is competitive on price and DPDP fit. Recommend leading with the zero-raw-video privacy story which simplifies the IT security review.
- **Top private universities, IITs, IIMs.** Mixed-vendor evaluation. Mercer Mettl tends to win where vendor stability is the procurement priority; Procta wins where IT teams care about architecture and cost.
- **Indian operations of MNCs (hiring-assessment use case).** Talview is the more natural incumbent. Procta is not currently the right fit; revisit once the assessment-authoring surface is broader.

10. References

All claims in this document are verifiable from the sources below. Internal Procta references point to specific files and migration phases in the proctored-browser repository.

Procta repository sources:

- `app/services/risk.py` - violation weights including `new_keyword_uttered` and `multiple_voices_detected` entries (phase 75).
- `audio_processor.py` - on-device Vosk + Silero VAD + MFCC clustering worker.
- `proctor.py` - kiosk lockdown, ML inference loop, ring-buffer audio feed, hardware governor.
- `migrations/phase73_violations_dismiss.sql` - cluster review dismissal columns.

- migrations/phase74_session_pause_terminate.sql - live intervention pause and termination columns.
- migrations/phase75_exam_audio_keywords.sql - per-exam audio keyword list.
- app/routers/billing.py - Razorpay subscription integration with UPI Autopay.
- website/src/pages/Privacy.jsx and Trust.jsx - public privacy and trust posture.
- website/src/pages/MigrateFromMettl.jsx and the three Compare* pages - public-facing migration arguments.

Competitor sources:

- Mercer Mettl: mettl.com product pages; Mercer 2018 acquisition press release; LinkedIn company page.
- Talview: talview.com product pages (Proview); Crunchbase funding rounds; LinkedIn company page.
- Proctortrack / Verificent: verificent.com / proctortrack.com product pages; published US higher-ed case studies.
- Honorlock: honorlock.com product pages; Long Ridge Equity Partners 2021 announcement; public case studies from the University of Florida and Arizona State.
- DPDP Act 2023: Government of India gazette notification dated 11 August 2023.

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